EXCELLENCE IN HISTORICAL SCHOLARSHIP • KEY STAGE 3 & GCSE

The History Department

Inspiring intellectual curiosity, evidential rigour, and critical independence

★ OPEN EVENING GUIDE • 2026–2027 ★

CHRONOLOGICAL BREADTH | PRIMARY EVIDENCE | ANALYTICAL WRITING | LIVING HISTORY

YEARS 7, 8 & 9 ENQUIRY

The KS3 Journey

A RICH CHRONOLOGICAL NARRATIVE



Primary Record: Bayeux Tapestry (c. 1070s) • Duke William Rallies the Normans at Hastings

Year 7: Medieval Britain & Health 1066–1500

"How did conquest and public health transform medieval society?"

- **Norman Subjugation (1066–87):** Feudal hierarchy, Domesday survey, and motte-and-bailey castle network.
- **Church, Crown & Law:** Becket's murder 1170, Magna Carta 1215, and the roots of parliamentary power.
- **Pandemic & Rebellion:** The catastrophic 1348 Black Death and the radical 1381 Peasants' Revolt.

Year 8: Early Modern & Empire 1500–1900

"To what extent did religious upheaval, empire and steam reshape Britain?"

- **Reformation & Regicide:** Break with Rome, English Civil War, and the 1649 execution of Charles I.
- **Enslavement & Resistance:** Transatlantic trade, plantation rebellion, and Equiano's abolition campaign.
- **Industrial Revolution & Empire:** Steam power, child labour reform, and British expansion in India and Australia.

Year 9: Conflict & Modernity 1900–Present

"Was the twentieth-century global crisis inevitable?"

- **The Great War (1914–18):** Alliance systems, imperial rivalries, trench warfare, and Western Front trauma.
- **Totalitarian Dictatorships:** Weimar democracy collapse, economic depression, and the rise of Fascism.
- **The Holocaust & Modernity:** Nazi persecution and liberation, followed by the Welfare State and Windrush.

EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1)

Academic Rigour

SPECIFICATION 1HI0 IN-DEPTH STUDY



Paper 2 Depth Study: Queen Elizabeth I & The Tudor Golden Age (Hilliard, 1585)

Paper 1: Thematic Breadth 30% • 1 hr 15m

Medicine in Britain c1250–Present & Western Front

- **Thematic Evolution:** Medieval Galenism → Renaissance anatomy (Vesalius & Harvey) → Germ Theory → Modern NHS.
- **Western Front Sector:** RAMC evacuation chain (RAP, Dressing Stations, Casualty Clearing Stations, Base Hospitals).
- **Clinical Innovation Under Fire:** Trench foot, gas gangrene, mobile X-rays, blood transfusions, and Thomas splints.

Paper 2: Period & Depth 40% • 1 hr 45m

Elizabethan England (1558–88) & Middle East (1945–95)

- **Early Elizabethan England:** Religious Settlement 1559, Catholic plots, Mary Queen of Scots, and the Spanish Armada.
- **Age of Discovery:** Sir Francis Drake's circumnavigation, Roanoke colonisation, and Elizabethan theatre culture.
- **Conflict in the Middle East:** UN Partition 1947, Suez Crisis 1956, Six-Day War 1967, and Camp David Accords 1978.

Paper 3: Modern Depth 30% • 1 hr 20m

Weimar & Nazi Germany (1918–39)

- **The Weimar Republic:** Versailles impact, 1923 hyperinflation crisis, and Stresemann's golden recovery.
- **Rise of Totalitarianism:** Wall Street Crash, mass unemployment, propaganda appeals, and Hitler's appointment in 1933.
- **Life Under the Police State:** The Gestapo terror network, social control of youth and women, and church opposition.

LIVING HISTORY & CAREERS

Beyond the Desk

FIELDWORK, HERITAGE & HORIZONS



Ypres Cloth Hall



Tyne Cot Cemetery

Ypres & Flanders Fieldwork Years 10 & 11

Key Stage 4 Residential Battlefield Study Tour

- **Walking the Historic Front Line:** Tyne Cot Cemetery, Langemark, and preserved trenches at Hill 62 Sanctuary Wood.
- **The Last Post at Menin Gate:** Participating in the poignant evening act of remembrance for the fallen.
- **Medicine Under Fire:** Investigating Essex Farm Advanced Dressing Station, linking directly to GCSE Paper 1.

Hampshire Archival Studies Local Study

Primary Document Scholarship

- **Parish & Census Records:** Deciphering authentic 18th & 19th-century county archival registers and rolls.
- **Naval & Industrial Heritage:** Portsmouth Royal Dockyard history and Henry Cort's iron innovations at Fontley.
- **Medieval Fortifications:** Field study of Portchester Castle and Winchester's Great Hall.

Where History Leads Career Paths

Transferable Disciplinary Rigour

- **Law & The Bar:** Evidential cross-examination, assessing credibility, and structuring persuasive cases.
- **Journalism & Diplomacy:** Investigative enquiry, bias detection, political writing, and civil service policy.
- **Finance & Strategy:** Dissecting complex historical trends, risk management, and strategic decision-making.

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1 **Browse the Materials:** Inspect our complete collection of KS3 & GCSE printed pupil workbooks on the display tables.

2 **Scan on Your Phone:** Open your smartphone camera to scan our QR codes and explore the interactive Revision Hub, digital textbooks, and quizzes.

3 **Speak With Us:** Our Head of History and teaching specialists are here to answer any questions about our curriculum.